

Microsoft Outlook

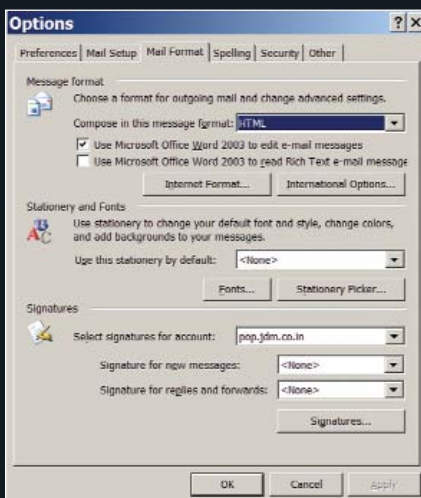
Outlook has its share of annoyances. Here's how you tackle the most common ones

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1. Rich Text messages don't show up properly

Reason: When you compose a message in the Rich Text Format—and the default setting on some versions of Outlook is 'Rich Text', what the recipient sees is not the mail you composed but a blank mail with an attachment called 'winmail.dat.' This happens with most receiving e-mail clients.

Solution: To fix this, go to Tools>Options and click the 'Mail Format' tab. Change the 'Compose in this message format' setting to 'HTML' or to 'Plain Text,' whichever you prefer.



Change the default messaging format to HTML; your default is probably Rich Text Format

2. Inbox opens too slowly

Reason: When you have a lot of mails in your Inbox, Outlook opens rather slowly.

Solution: Use Outlook's AutoArchive option to archive old mails. There are probably several mails in your inbox right now that don't need your attention, but are there just for reference. You can tell Outlook to archive old messages automatically. What Outlook does is to put these mails in another folder, which it calls archive.pst by default. Go to Tools>Options and open the 'Other' tab. Here, click 'AutoArchive' and you will see all the options available to you. You can



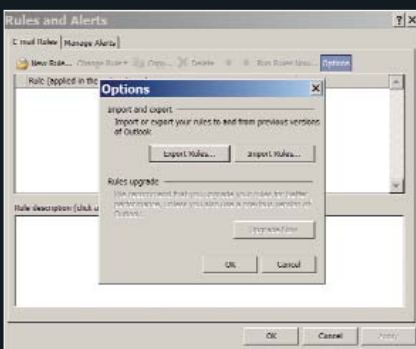
Set the 'AutoArchive' option to 'Archive Unused Messages Every Few Days'

choose how often you want AutoArchive to run, whether or not to delete old items permanently and so on.

3. Mail rules don't get retained when you re-install Outlook

Reason: When you migrate to or re-install Outlook, you can save all your mails by keeping the .pst files in a safe location. After re-installation, you can instruct Outlook to use that .pst file and all your mails and settings will be safe and secure. However, mail rules don't get saved in the .pst file. So when you think you have got it right, you suddenly find that all your mail rules have vanished!

Solution: Export your rules before you re-install. To do this, go to Tools>Rules and



Export your rules before you migrate your Outlook and re-import them after you are done

Alerts, and here, find and click the 'Options' button. Here you will find the 'Export Rules' button. Click it and then export your rules to any safe location on your hard disk. Repeat the process after re-installation and this time, select 'Import Rules' and point it to where you saved the rules before.

4. Outlook XP doesn't open .exe attachments

Reason: At times, you may need to download the kinds of attachments that Outlook XP blocks by default. There is no feature in Outlook XP itself that allows you to enable downloading these attachments.

Solution: To enable Outlook XP to download certain attachment types, you need to do the following: First, open the registry editor. Expand the branches to HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Office\10.0\Outlook\Security. Now, create a new string value by selecting 'New' and then 'String Value' from the Edit menu. Name the new value 'Level1Remove'. Double-click the new 'Level1Remove' to edit it and enter the filename extensions you would like to stop Outlook from blocking. Extensions should be typed in lower case, without the dots and separated by semicolons. For example, type in exe;mdb;vbs to allow .exe, .mdb and .vbs attachments respectively. Click OK and close the registry editor. You may have to restart Outlook for this change to take effect.

5. Contacts don't seem to work even though they are there

Reason: When you re-install or migrate to Outlook, all your contacts are saved—but when you try composing a mail to any one contact or in any other way try to use a contact from the list, Outlook seems to ignore the contacts. It appears as though the contact list isn't working, even though you can see that the list is there.

Solution: It's simple. Right-click on the contacts folder, then choose 'Properties'. Click the 'Outlook Address Book' tab. Here, tickmark the 'Show this folder as an e-mail address book' checkbox. You're ready to go! ☑

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